SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 209

**WHEREAS,** The Senate of the State of Texas is pleased to recognize the Veterans Band of Corpus Christi on the occasion of its 40th anniversary; and

**WHEREAS,** The Veterans Band of Corpus Christi was established in June of 1986 to honor our nation's military members and families and to provide live music in the spirit of solemnity and grandeur that is inherent in patriotic ceremonies; and

**WHEREAS,** The band is composed of veterans from each branch of the United States Armed Forces, whose shared commitment to service continues through music; and

**WHEREAS,** The Veterans Band of Corpus Christi owes its existence and enduring success to its founder and director, Ram Chavez, a Vietnam veteran who served as a combat medic and whose courage and sacrifice were recognized with the Purple Heart and Silver Star; Ram's vision, leadership, and tireless dedication over the past four decades have made this band a success that is greatly admired by all; and

**WHEREAS,** Through the previous four decades, the Veterans Band of Corpus Christi has performed at an impressive array of commemorative and celebratory events in South Texas and across the nation; its longstanding service has been honored by many local and national organizations and public leaders; and

**WHEREAS,** In paying tribute to the sacrifices of our servicemembers, the Veterans Band of Corpus Christi has fostered a deeper appreciation for those who have faithfully defended the freedoms we cherish, and it is indeed deserving of recognition for carrying on a proud and time-honored tradition of patriotism and respect in the community; now, therefore, be it

**PROCLAIMED,** That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby commend the Veterans Band of Corpus Christi on 40 years of outstanding musicianship and extend to its members best wishes for continued success; and, be it further

**PROCLAIMED,** That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for the band as an expression of high regard from the Texas Senate.

Hinojosa of Hidalgo

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate